

links pointing in to your site, the greater is the chance of increasing your page rank too.

The same technique of promoting your website on twitter can be used. Except with twitter it's better to have a personal account and occasionally plug in your business rather than having a twitter account with your company name. Tweeple are generally averse to following companies. What you need to do is build a personality for your twitter account. One important point to remember is not to be part of a community, be it twitter, Facebook, or forums and talk incessantly about your product. Like any real life interaction with other people you must listen and make meaningful contributions. Posting only self-serving links will cause you more harm in the long run.

You should also be using social media tools of the old world. What we're talking about are discussion groups, message boards and email groups. The Internet offers hundreds of targeted e-mail based discussion lists, online forums, and groups made up of people with very specialised interests and common goals. Find groups on Yahoo groups related to hosting and domain name registration, cybersquatting etc. and you can begin plugging your website a little each day. But rather than blatant plugging you should be subtle about it by putting your website name and tag line in the signature of your mails. You can even have it as your gtalk status.

6.6 Pro bono work, a good starting point

Probono work is basically doing work for free initially to begin with. Yes, it may sound absurd. Why should I work for free? Granted you're in this business to make money so why would you want to do work for free? The idea is to do work for free for local charities and local NGO groups so that you get references and testimonials from them. It will also help you build your portfolio initially. For doing this you need to come up with innovative ways in which you can engage local charities. Maybe it's a local Ganesh Utsav Mandal, a local school, a local center for the blind or even a local temple etc. Most of these organisations will not pass up on the opportunity of having a web presence. It will be your job to figure out how innovatively you can provide value to them. Some of these organisations may even be willing to give you basic domain registration charges as long as you do the task of designing a basic website for them. You can also exploit your natural network and gain a foot hold in the web hosting space locally. Friends, family and friends-of-friends can be contacted for gaining pro bono work. 